

Terrain Convergence and Report Distribution in the Holstonia Region

A Preliminary Landscape Analysis of Five Investigated Encounters

Daniel H. Kegley
holstonia-investigations.org

Version of Record: This document constitutes the authoritative version of this work. Please cite the version available at holstonia-investigations.org. Revised editions, if issued, will be explicitly identified.

© Dan Kegley, 2026

Abstract

Anomalous biological reports, including those commonly associated with “Bigfoot” or “Sasquatch,” are often treated as isolated anecdotal claims. However, reports themselves constitute observational data shaped by environmental and human factors. This study analyzes five independently investigated encounter reports within the Holstonia region of the southern Appalachians to evaluate whether report locations exhibit recurring terrain and land-use patterns. Results indicate encounters cluster where forest cover, water corridors, and limited human access intersect—conditions defined here as **Report Convergence Zones (RCZs)**. These findings suggest reports are not randomly distributed but correlate with predictable landscape mechanics influencing both wildlife movement and human detection opportunities. This paper does not address species identity; rather, it demonstrates that terrain analysis provides a neutral, testable framework for evaluating report distribution under conditions of uncertainty.

1. Introduction

Debates surrounding anomalous biological claims often focus prematurely on questions of existence or identity. Such debates obscure a more tractable scientific question:

Are encounter reports randomly distributed, or do they cluster in predictable environmental contexts?

Holstonia investigations approach reports as data points generated at the intersection of terrain structure, wildlife movement, and human access. Independent of biological conclusions, environmental mechanics determine where encounters are most likely to be observed.

This study analyzes five independently investigated encounter reports to evaluate terrain patterns influencing report occurrence.

2. Analytical Framework

Holstonia research treats reports as observational events shaped by:

- landscape structure,
- ecological movement corridors,
- human activity patterns, and
- detectability constraints.

Rather than evaluating biological claims, this analysis focuses on environmental conditions that create opportunities for observation.

The central hypothesis tested here:

Reports cluster where terrain, cover, and access structures intersect to increase detection opportunities.

3. Case Selection

Five reported encounters were selected based on:

- direct investigation or investigator corroboration,
- sufficient terrain description,
- independent witness consistency in several cases, and
- geographic distribution within the Holstonia region.

The cases include:

1. A hollow near the North Fork Holston River involving vocalizations and visual observation.
2. A National Forest hunter encounter associated with skid-road and creek corridors.
3. Repeated residential-edge interactions involving nocturnal disturbances.
4. A roadside interstate encounter involving fleeing wildlife and a brief visual sighting.
5. A multi-investigator encounter on a slope above a lakeshore trail, corroborated by a separate shoreline report.

4. Terrain Characteristics of Investigated Sites

4.1 Continuous Forest Cover

All reported encounters occurred within or adjacent to substantial forest cover permitting concealed movement.

4.2 Water-Connected Corridors

Each site lies near rivers, lakes, or drainage systems providing wildlife movement pathways and predictable visitation zones.

4.3 Limited Human Density

Reported encounters occurred where human presence is intermittent rather than constant, reducing disturbance while allowing occasional intersection with travel routes.

4.4 Corridor Intersection with Human Access

Encounter reports occur where natural movement routes intersect with:

- hunting access,
 - hiking trails,
 - rural residences, or
 - transportation corridors.
-

4.5 Immediate Escape Terrain

Reported subjects consistently departed into terrain permitting rapid concealment, including:

- uphill ridge crossings,
 - drainage entry, or
 - immediate forest cover.
-

5. Report Convergence Zones (RCZ)

Based on these observations, we define:

Report Convergence Zone (RCZ):

A landscape area where terrain, vegetation cover, water systems, and human access routes intersect in ways that increase the frequency of encounter reports relative to surrounding terrain.

Observed RCZ types include:

1. Interior forest corridor intersections.
2. Forest–residential or forest–pasture edges.
3. Transportation corridor crossings.
4. Water–slope interface zones.
5. Hollow or drainage junctions.

RCZ designation reflects observation opportunity rather than biological presence.

6. Interpretation

Terrain patterns influence encounter mechanics regardless of the underlying explanation for reports. Whether encounters represent misidentifications, rare wildlife observations, or unknown biological phenomena, environmental structure governs:

- movement concealment,
- exposure likelihood, and
- detection opportunities.

Terrain therefore provides an analytically neutral framework for evaluating report distribution without presupposing biological conclusions.

7. Limitations

This study is constrained by:

- small sample size,
- subjective components in reports,
- geographic concentration, and
- absence of physical evidence analysis.

Findings should therefore be interpreted as preliminary terrain correlations rather than definitive ecological conclusions.

8. Conclusions

Analysis of five investigated encounters indicates reports cluster within predictable landscape contexts rather than appearing randomly distributed.

Encounter reports occur where:

- continuous cover exists,
- water-connected movement corridors are present,
- human access intersects those corridors, and
- immediate concealment terrain is available.

These Report Convergence Zones provide a framework for terrain-based analysis of anomalous biological reports independent of species claims.

9. Future Directions

Future research should:

- expand datasets under standardized coding schemes,
- incorporate quantitative spatial modeling,
- compare regions lacking reports, and
- integrate observer effort and detectability models.

Such work will allow terrain-based hypotheses to be evaluated statistically rather than anecdotally.

Acknowledgments

The author acknowledges investigators and witnesses whose cooperation enabled terrain reconstruction of reported encounters and recognizes regional research traditions informing Holstonia investigations.

Holstonia
Bigfoot 
Investigations
From Anomaly to Analysis